



IV MUN
2026



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STUDY GUIDE

UNITED NATIONS SECURITY COUNCIL



AGENDA:

Ensuring the Protection of Civilians
and Accountability for Human Rights
Violations in Sudan



DELIBERATE

Engage in informed
and respectful
debate.



NEGOTIATE

Build consensus
through diplomacy
and cooperation.



LEGISLATE

Draft strong
resolutions that
drive change.



PROTECT

Uphold international
peace, security, and
human dignity.



ACCOUNT

Promote justice
and accountability
for all.

“ The United Nations was not created to take mankind to heaven,
but to save humanity from hell. ”

– Dag Hammarskjöld



UNDERSTANDING THE SECURITY COUNCIL

The United Nations Security Council (UNSC) is the primary organ responsible for the maintenance of international peace and security. It has the unique authority to make decisions that are legally binding on all UN Member States.



MANDATE & POWERS

Established under Chapter V of the UN Charter, the Security Council has the responsibility for maintaining international peace and security. It can:



INVESTIGATE any dispute or situation that might lead to international friction.



RECOMMEND methods of settlement or terms of adjustment.



DECIDE on the existence of a threat to peace, breach of peace, or act of aggression.



IMPOSE measures, including sanctions, to maintain or restore peace.



AUTHORIZE the use of force under Chapter VII when necessary.



ESTABLISH peacekeeping operations to support the implementation of its decisions.



COMPOSITION

15 MEMBER STATES

5

PERMANENT MEMBERS (P5)



United States United Kingdom France Russia China

10

NON-PERMANENT MEMBERS (ELECTED FOR 2-YEAR TERMS)



Elected by the General Assembly ensuring equitable geographical representation.

ELECTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY



★ Membership is based on contributions to international peace, not on financial contributions to the UN.



THE VETO POWER



The five permanent members hold the power of veto.

If any one of them votes "No" on a substantive matter, the resolution fails to adopt, even if all other members vote in favor.



The veto does not apply to procedural matters.



VOTING PROCEDURE

TYPE OF MATTER	REQUIRED VOTES
 Procedural Matters (e.g., meeting schedule, rules of procedure)	Affirmative votes of any 9 members (P5 cannot veto)
 Substantive Matters (e.g., sanctions, peacekeeping, use of force)	At least 9 affirmative votes including the concurring votes of all P5 members (no veto)



HOW A RESOLUTION IS ADOPTED



1

INTRODUCTION

A member introduces a draft resolution.



2

CONSIDERATION

The Council discusses the draft in formal or informal meetings.



3

NEGOTIATION

Delegates negotiate text, consult informally, and build consensus.



4

VOTING

The draft is put to a vote on procedural and then substantive grounds.



5

ADOPTION

If adopted, the resolution becomes binding on all UN Member States.



TYPES OF RESOLUTIONS

CHAPTER VI (PEACEFUL SETTLEMENT)



Aim to resolve disputes through negotiation, mediation, arbitration, or other peaceful means.

CHAPTER VII (ACTIONS WITH ENFORCEMENT)



Allow the Council to take enforcement measures including sanctions and authorizing the use of force.



OBJECTIVES OF THE COUNCIL

- ✓ Maintain international peace and security.
- ✓ Prevent conflicts and resolve disputes peacefully.
- ✓ Promote respect for human rights and international law.
- ✓ Protect civilians in armed conflict.
- ✓ Ensure accountability for violations that threaten peace.
- ✓ Support sustainable peace through political solutions.



BACKGROUND TO THE AGENDA: THE SUDAN CRISIS

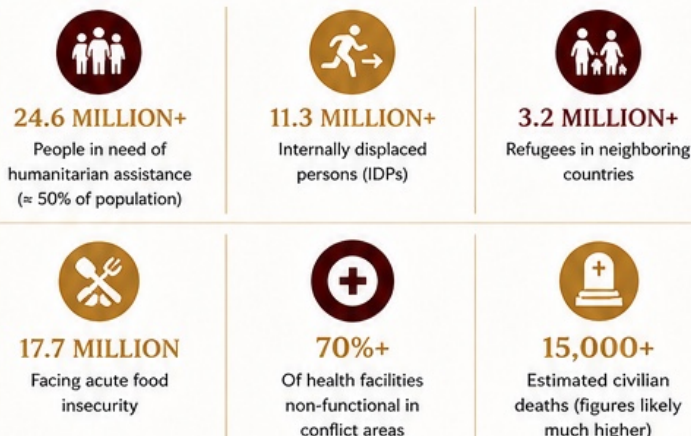
“ The people of Sudan have endured decades of conflict and instability. Today, they face one of the world’s gravest humanitarian crises. ”

Sudan has been in turmoil since April 2023, when tensions between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) escalated into full-scale armed conflict. The fighting has triggered widespread human rights violations, massive displacement, and a severe humanitarian catastrophe.

TIMELINE OF KEY EVENTS

- December 2018 – April 2019**
Nationwide protests against President Omar al-Bashir lead to his overthrow after 30 years in power.
- August 2019**
Transitional government formed: Sovereign Council and Prime Minister to lead the country to democratic elections.
- October 2021**
Military coup led by General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan (SAF), halting the transition and dissolving civilian leadership.
- Late 2022 – Early 2023**
Growing tensions between SAF and RSF over integration into a unified national army and power-sharing.
- 15 April 2023**
Armed clashes erupt in Khartoum between SAF and RSF, spreading rapidly across the country.
- Mid 2023 – Present**
Conflict expands to Darfur, Kordofan, and other regions. Persistent fighting, atrocities, and humanitarian crisis worsen.
- 2024 – 2026**
Multiple ceasefire attempts fail. International mediation continues but no lasting peace achieved.

CURRENT SITUATION (AS OF MAY 2026)



! The actual numbers are likely higher due to lack of access, breakdown of services, and ongoing violence.

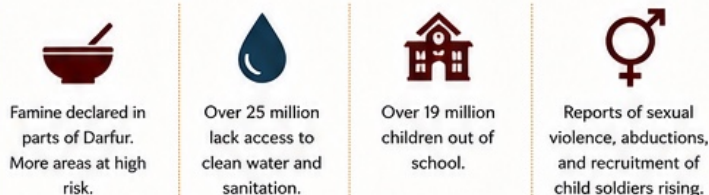
THE CONFLICT: WHERE IS IT HAPPENING?



KEY DRIVERS OF THE CONFLICT

- Power Struggle**
Rivalry between SAF (led by Gen. al-Burhan) and RSF (led by Gen. Hemedti) over control of the state and integration of forces.
- Breakdown of the Transition**
The 2021 coup derailed the political transition and deepened public mistrust in military leadership.
- Ethnic & Regional Dimensions**
Violence in Darfur and other regions has ethnic undertones, exacerbating historical grievances.
- Economic Collapse**
Years of mismanagement, corruption, and conflict have led to hyperinflation, unemployment, and poverty.
- External Interference**
Regional and international actors have been accused of providing political, financial, or military support.

HUMANITARIAN SNAPSHOT



Humanitarian organizations face severe access constraints, security risks, and funding shortages.

WHAT IS THE CONFLICT ABOUT?

At its core, the crisis is a battle for power between two military factions that were once allies:

 SAF (Sudanese Armed Forces) The regular national army, considered the de jure security force of Sudan.	 RSF (Rapid Support Forces) A paramilitary group that evolved from the Janjaweed militia and gained political and military influence.
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Their conflict has devastated communities, destroyed infrastructure, and pushed the country to the brink of collapse.

“ Peace is not merely the absence of war, but the presence of justice, dignity, and hope. ”

– United Nations



INTERNATIONAL RESPONSE & KEY STAKEHOLDERS

The scale and complexity of the Sudan crisis demand a coordinated international response that upholds international law, protects civilians, and ensures accountability for grave human rights violations.



UN ACTIONS TO DATE



UNSC Meetings & Statements

Multiple briefings held since April 2023. The Council has issued press statements condemning violence and calling for the protection of civilians.



UN Missions & Envoys

The Personal Envoy of the Secretary-General for Sudan has engaged regional and international actors to facilitate dialogue and de-escalation.



Humanitarian Assistance

UN agencies (OCHA, WFP, WHO, UNICEF) are providing life-saving aid but face severe access constraints and funding gaps.



Human Rights Monitoring

OHCHR has documented widespread human rights abuses and violations of IHL by all parties to the conflict.



Sanctions & Arms Embargo

The UNSC has imposed an arms embargo on Darfur (Resolution 1591 (2005)) which remains in place. Targeted sanctions exist on individuals undermining peace.



Fact-Finding & Reporting

Independent Experts and mechanisms continue to collect evidence for accountability and future prosecutions.



REGIONAL & INTERNATIONAL ACTORS



African Union (AU)

Leading mediation efforts through the AU High-Level Panel and the Quad mechanism.



IGAD

Facilitating dialogue and coordination between regional states to support peace initiatives.



Arab League

Advocating for ceasefire, protection of civilians, and political solutions in Sudan.



European Union (EU)

Providing humanitarian aid and supporting peace and accountability.



United States (US)

Imposing targeted sanctions and pushing for a civilian-led democratic transition.



INTERNATIONAL CRIMINAL COURT (ICC)

The ICC is investigating alleged war crimes, crimes against humanity, and genocide in Darfur since 2005. Ongoing atrocities in Darfur and other regions may fall under the Court's jurisdiction.

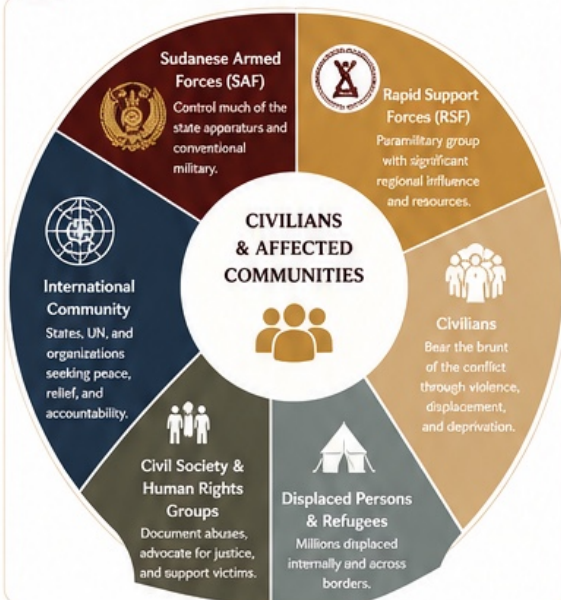


HUMANITARIAN ORGANIZATIONS

ICRC | MSF | Save the Children | Oxfam | NRC | CARE International
Working on the ground to deliver aid, shelter, healthcare, protection, and advocacy for civilians.



STAKEHOLDER MAP



BLOC POSITIONS & INTERESTS

BLOC / GROUP	KEY MEMBERS	INTERESTS & APPROACH
 P5 (Permanent Members)		United in call for protection of civilians; differ on the use of enforcement measures and sanctions.
 African Group		Prioritizes African-led solutions, sovereignty, and non-interference with strong emphasis on humanitarian access.
 Arab Group		Supports ceasefire, political transition, and accountability for violations.
 Western European and Others (WEOG)		Advocates for human rights, accountability, sanctions on perpetrators, and humanitarian protection.
 Non-Aligned Movement (NAM)		Focus on dialogue, peaceful settlement, respect for sovereignty, and balanced approach to sanctions.



KEY CHALLENGES TO ADDRESS



Ongoing Violence
Persistent fighting and atrocities continue across multiple regions.



Access Constraints
Humanitarian access is severely restricted by insecurity and bureaucratic barriers.



Fragmented Governance
Lack of unified civilian leadership and political fragmentation.



Accountability Gap
Perpetrators of grave violations often act with impunity.



Funding Shortfalls
Humanitarian response is critically underfunded.



Regional Spillover
Instability risks spreading to neighboring countries.

WHY THIS MATTERS

“The people of Sudan deserve peace, dignity, and justice. Addressing this crisis is not only a moral imperative but essential for regional stability and the credibility of the international system.”

”



*Protect civilians. Uphold justice.
Build lasting peace.*



PREPARING FOR COMMITTEE

DEBATE SMART. NEGOTIATE WISELY. DRAFT IMPACTFULLY.

As a delegate, your role is to represent your country's position, build alliances, and work towards realistic solutions that protect civilians and uphold international peace and security.



KEY QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

- 01 What is your country's position on the conflict in Sudan and why?
- 02 How can the Council protect civilians while respecting state sovereignty?
- 03 What accountability mechanisms are effective and realistic?
- 04 Should the Council impose sanctions or an arms embargo? Why or why not?
- 05 How can humanitarian access be ensured across all conflict-affected regions?
- 06 What role should regional organizations (AU, IGAD) play in the solution?
- 07 How can a sustainable ceasefire and political process be achieved?



DRAFT RESOLUTION: STRUCTURE

PART I	Preambulatory Clauses	Set the context, express concerns, and establish the legal basis.
PART II	Operative Clauses	Contain the action-oriented provisions and solutions.
PART III	Final Clauses	Include review, reporting, and implementation.
PART IV	Signatories	The resolution is submitted for consideration and adoption.



SAMPLE PREAMBULATORY CLAUSES

- Recalling relevant resolutions on the situation in Sudan, including UNSCR 1591 (2005) and 2719 (2023),
- Deeply concerned about the deteriorating humanitarian situation in Sudan and the grave impact on civilians,
- Reaffirming the purposes and principles of the Charter of the United Nations,
- Emphasizing the responsibility of all parties to comply with international humanitarian law and human rights law,
- Recognizing the efforts of the African Union and IGAD in promoting peace, security, and stability in Sudan,
- Expressing grave concern over reports of war crimes, crimes against humanity, and ethnic violence,
- Stressing that impunity perpetuates conflict and instability,
- Acting under Chapter VI/VII of the Charter of the United Nations,



SAMPLE OPERATIVE CLAUSES

- 1 Demands an immediate and unconditional ceasefire by all parties in Sudan;
- 2 Calls for the protection of civilians, including women, children, and humanitarian workers;
- 3 Authorizes the deployment of a UN protection mission with a robust mandate;
- 4 Imposes an arms embargo on all parties to the conflict;
- 5 Establishes an independent investigative mechanism to ensure accountability;
- 6 Urges all parties to ensure safe and unhindered humanitarian access across Sudan;
- 7 Requests the Secretary-General to report back within 60 days on implementation;
- 8 Decides to remain actively seized of the matter.



POSSIBLE SOLUTIONS

- Immediate nationwide ceasefire and silencing of weapons.
- Deployment of a UN peacekeeping or protection mission.
- Targeted sanctions and arms embargo on parties obstructing peace.
- Independent investigation and accountability for atrocities.
- Support for inclusive political dialogue and transitional governance.
- Strengthening humanitarian access and funding for relief operations.
- Protection of human rights defenders, journalists, and aid workers.



MOTIONS IN UNSC

MOTION	PURPOSE
Point of Order	To raise a parliamentary or procedural issue.
Point of Information	To ask for clarification on a statement.
Point of Personal Privilege	To address comfort or technical issues.
Request for Caucus	To have an informal discussion.
Motion to Amend	To modify a clause in the draft resolution.
Motion to Divide the Question	To vote on a specific part of a resolution separately.
Motion for a Roll Call Vote	To request a recorded vote.
Motion to Table	To postpone the discussion temporarily.
Motion to Close Debate	To end the debate and proceed to voting.



CAUCUS STRATEGY



Build Alliances Early
Identify countries with similar views and common interests.



Be Flexible
Compromise on language, not principles.



Use Informal Caucuses
Lobby, negotiate, and refine your ideas.



Propose Constructive Ideas
Bring solutions, not just criticisms.



Stay Informed
Follow updates, statements, and negotiations.



DELEGATE CHECKLIST

- ☐ Understand your country's position and key interests.
- ☐ Research the conflict, stakeholders, and international law.
- ☐ Prepare briefing notes and potential solutions.
- ☐ Identify allies and potential partners.
- ☐ Prepare opening speech (1–1.5 minutes).
- ☐ Participate in caucuses and negotiations.
- ☐ Listen, engage, and stay diplomatic.
- ☐ Help draft strong, effective resolutions.
- ☐ Stay professional, respectful, and inclusive.



*Justice delayed in Sudan is justice denied to millions.
The Security Council must act with unity, courage, and compassion.*



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*Good legislation today,
a more peaceful tomorrow.*



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APPENDIX

KEY REFERENCES & RESOURCES

Use this appendix as a quick reference for essential legal frameworks, key terms, and research resources to strengthen your performance in committee.



IMPORTANT UN CHARTER ARTICLES

Article 24	Confers primary responsibility on the Security Council for the maintenance of international peace and security.
Article 39	Empowers the Council to determine the existence of any threat to the peace, breach of peace, or act of aggression.
Article 41	Allows the Council to decide on measures not involving the use of armed force (e.g., sanctions, embargoes).
Article 42	Authorizes the Council to take action by air, sea, or land forces when measures under Article 41 are inadequate.
Article 50	Allows the Council to use UN military forces for enforcement action.
Article 51	Recognizes the inherent right of individual or collective self-defense if an armed attack occurs.
Article 52	Empowers regional arrangements to deal with matters relating to the maintenance of international peace.

INTERNATIONAL HUMANITARIAN LAW (IHL)

KEY PRINCIPLES				
				
Distinction Parties must distinguish between combatants and civilians.	Protection Civilians and civilian objects must be protected.	Proportionality Attacks must not cause excessive civilian harm.	Military Necessity Use only the minimum force necessary.	Humanity Treat all persons humanely; prohibit torture, cruel treatment, and collective punishment.
RELEVANT TREATIES & INSTRUMENTS				
• Geneva Conventions (1949) & Additional Protocols (1977) • Convention Against Torture (1984) • Rome Statute of the International Criminal Court (1998) • Convention on the Protection of Civilians in Armed Conflict (various)				

RESPONSIBILITY TO PROTECT (R2P)

Endorsed by all UN Member States in 2005, R2P holds that every state has the responsibility to protect its population from:



Genocide



War Crimes



Ethnic Cleansing



Crimes Against Humanity



When a state is unwilling or unable to protect its population, the international community has a responsibility to take collective action, through the UN Security Council, in a timely and decisive manner.

KEY TERMS TO KNOW

Ceasefire	A temporary suspension of fighting, often a first step toward peace.
Sanctions	Measures imposed to restrict a country's activities (travel bans, asset freezes, arms embargoes).
Arms Embargo	A ban on the supply, sale, or transfer of weapons and military equipment.
Accountability	Ensuring perpetrators of human rights violations are investigated, prosecuted, and held responsible.
Impunity	The failure to punish crimes, allowing perpetrators to act without fear.
IDPs	Internally Displaced Persons – people forced to flee their homes but remain within their country.
Refugees	Persons who flee their country due to conflict or persecution and cross an international border.

SUDAN CRISIS TIMELINE (AT A GLANCE)

- 2018–2019 Mass protests against President Omar al-Bashir lead to his removal.
- 2019 Transitional government formed; hopes for democratic transition.
- 2021 Military coup led by General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan.
- 15 April 2023 Armed clashes erupt between SAF and RSF in Khartoum.
- Mid 2023 Conflict spreads to Darfur, Kordofan, and other regions.
- 2024 Repeated ceasefire attempts; humanitarian crisis deepens.
- 2025–May 2026 Continued violence, mass displacement, and accountability efforts ongoing.



The conflict shows no sign of abating, requiring sustained international attention and action.

USEFUL RESEARCH FOCUS AREAS

	Human Rights Documentation	Reports by OHCHR, HRW, Amnesty International on violations in Sudan.
	Arms Flows & Financing	Sources of weapons and funding for warring parties.
	Peace Processes	Past and ongoing mediation efforts (e.g., Jeddah talks, AU initiatives).
	Accountability Mechanisms	ICC investigations, fact-finding missions, and evidence collection.
	Regional Dimensions	Impact on neighboring states, refugee flows, and regional security.
	Humanitarian Access	Challenges faced by organizations delivering aid in conflict zones.



DELEGATE REMINDERS

- ✓ Represent your country's policy, not your personal opinions.
- ✓ Respect the rules of procedure and your fellow delegates.
- ✓ Listen actively and build on others' ideas.
- ✓ Base arguments on facts, international law, and precedent.
- ✓ Seek common ground and propose realistic solutions.
- ✓ Stay diplomatic, even during disagreement.

“Effective diplomacy is not about winning arguments, but building peace.”



DELEGATE CHECKLIST

- ☐ Understand your country's position and interests.
- ☐ Identify allies, partners, and possible blocs.
- ☐ Research the crisis, legal frameworks, and recent developments.
- ☐ Prepare opening speech (1–1.5 minutes).
- ☐ Prepare ideas for resolutions and amendments.
- ☐ Bring facts, statistics, and credible sources.
- ☐ Stay updated and adaptable.

